
Introduction to AI

[Click to schedule a meeting with the DITI Team](#)

Summary

This handout provides a brief introduction for students to AI in an academic context. It introduces key terms in AI; lists AI-powered tools [currently subscribed to by Northeastern](#); and provides further resources on fair use, copyright, and data ethics.

Key Terms

- [Artificial Intelligence](#) (AI): Technology that utilizes pre-defined rules or finds patterns in data to imitate human intelligence.
- [Training](#): The process of finding patterns in data and storing these in a model to apply to future tasks.
- [AI Model](#): An AI system component that produces outputs inferred from inputs.
- [Generative AI](#) (GenAI): AI models that are trained on large datasets of text, images, or other content in order to create generated content that replicates patterns in the training data in response to instructions from a user. These models are prone to issues including [bias](#) and [hallucination](#).
- [Prompt Engineering](#): The process of writing and revising instructions or requests (called prompts) to a generative AI in order to receive a specific output.

AI-Powered Tools at Northeastern

Northeastern University provides students with free access to [Scopus AI](#), [Claude](#), and [Microsoft Copilot Chat](#). Below is a summary of each tool:

- [Scopus AI](#) helps summarize academic literature, including articles, books, and conference papers. It uses generative AI to write a summary of literature relevant to a question. To use Scopus AI, go to <https://www-scopus-com.ezproxy.neu.edu/pages/home?display=basic#scopus-ai> and log in with your Northeastern credentials. For more information see our handout on [Scopus AI](#).
- [Claude](#) is a general purpose AI assistant that can help with a variety of academic tasks. To use Claude, go to <https://claude.northeastern.edu/>, click Log in with SSO, and log in using your Northeastern credentials.
- [Microsoft Copilot Chat](#) is integrated in Microsoft 365 applications, such as Outlook, and can help with administrative tasks. To [use Microsoft Copilot Chat](#), go to <https://copilot.microsoft.com> and log in using your Northeastern credentials (select “sign in with Microsoft”).

Digital Integration Teaching Initiative

Further Resources

Northeastern hosts a wide variety of AI [initiatives](#) and [research hubs](#). Below are some resources that you may find useful as you are starting out with using AI in an academic context.

Northeastern University Library

- [Research Tutorials: Generative AI](#)
- [Communication Studies: AI tools for your research](#)
- [Communication Sciences & Disorders: Find Articles](#)

Northeastern University Policies

- [Academic Integrity Policy](#)
- [Policy on the Use of Artificial Intelligence Systems](#)
- [FAQs on the University Policy on Use of Artificial Intelligence](#)
- [Standards and Recommendations for the Use of Generative AI in Teaching and Learning](#)
- [Standards for the Use of Artificial Intelligence in Research](#)

Digital Integration Teaching Initiative (DITI) Resources

- [Introduction to AI Ethics](#) Handout
- [Data Ethics](#) Handout
- [Data Privacy](#) Handout
- [Copyright and Fair Use](#) Handout
- [AI for Literature Reviews](#) Slides

Center for Advancing Teaching and Learning Through Research (CATRL) Resources

- [AI in Teaching & Learning Across the Network](#)
- [Tips, Tutorials, & Recordings: For Students](#)
- [An Insider's Guide to Learning with AI](#) by Northeastern University's Office of the Provost, Office of the Chancellor, Center for Advancing Teaching and Learning through Research, and Office of Student Life